The Van with the Wrong Load

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 3

Two crates waited beside the delivery van. Nib loaded the largest first. When its lid lifted, velvet flags spilled over the edge. The glass pane remained in a smaller padded tray on the shelter floor. Lark unfolded the reserved-load strip from the lookout guide.

“Very valuable velvet flags,” Nib announced eagerly. “Very useful glass,” Lark replied firmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **jam**

“For v, touch top teeth to lower lip and add your voice: /v/,” Lark modeled clearly. “For f, the air flows without that voice. Compare van and fan. Our new v keeps its voice as we join it into van and vest.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try van, vet, vest. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read van on the reserved-load strip,” Lark invited gently. “Which pictured load does that whole strip assign to our journey?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can get it. Pat can not.**

“Which friend cannot get it?” Lark asked gently. “Read the whole second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the decorations to the shelter. The glass tray settled into the van's padded supports, with the fittings secured separately beside it. Lark checked that neither could slide across the other. The correct load was smaller and considerably more useful. The van reached a covered stopping place just as a shower began.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write v beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the actual load, then supplied the little missing spoken words when rereading the journal together. The glass was safely uphill, but its case cover stopped short of the lower edge. The rain had found the next practical question.